

100 Days of Azure DevOps

Day 19 Handout — Protect main with branch policies

Learning in public · Personal lab only · Educational content · Not a sales pitch

Architecture A — permissions vs policies

Control	Answers	Example
Repo permissions	Who can access	Readers / Contributors / Admins
Branch policies	How main changes	PR required, reviewers, work items, squash

Architecture B — policies on main

Policy	Lab baseline	Why it matters
Minimum reviewers	1 (solo OK)	No silent merges to main
Linked work items	Required	Boards ↔ Repos audit trail
Limit merge types	Squash only	Matches Day 12 ADR / clean history
Build validation	Optional now	Floor: red builds do not merge
Bypass policies	Break-glass only	Useful in emergencies; poisonous as habit

One-liner to remember

Branch policies are not bureaucracy · They are how you stop 2 AM from becoming archaeology

Step-by-step lab (20–30 min)

In project **azure-100-labs**:

- 1 Repos → Branches → **main** → Branch policies
- 2 Enable: min **1** reviewer, linked work items **Required**, squash-only merges
- 3 Prove the lock: attempt a direct commit/push to **main** (should fail)
- 4 Create **feature/day19-branch-policies**, open PR with linked work item, squash-merge
- 5 Write **docs/branch-policies.md** documenting the settings

UI path

Repos → Branches → main → ... → Branch policies
Baseline: reviewers=1 · work items=Required · merge=Squash

Done checklist

- Branch policies enabled on main
- Direct push blocked (or documented if admin bypass applies)
- PR path with linked work item + squash verified
- docs/branch-policies.md written

Tomorrow — Day 20

Phase 2 mini project & recap — Git mastery checkpoint.

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